# 058. Al Mujaadila ~ The Pleading One

22 Ayaat (Madani)

## FOCUS

DIVINITY'S RESPONSE TO THE PLEA OF A WOMAN
FAMILY AND SOCIAL ISSUES CONFRONTING A NEW MUSLIM COMMUNITY
HYPOCRISY EXPOSED
THE PARTY OF ALLAH IS SUCCESSFUL

## DID YOU KNOW?

THE CHAPTER IS NAMED AFTER THE PLEADING OF KHAWLA BINT THA'LABA TO THE PROPHET ABOUT THE WAY HER HUSBAND DIVORCED HER WITH A PRE-ISLAMIC PRACTICE WHERE SHE WAS NOT FREE TO CONTRACT ANOTHER MARRIAGE. IT LED TO A CHANGE OF LAW. THE SURA IS ALSO KNOWN AS AL ZIHAAR.

## SELECTED AYAAT

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| 58:1 | Allah hears the pleading one |
| 58:7 | He is at every secret counsel |
| 58:11 | Manners of assemblies (majlis) |

## NARRATIVE

IT TAKES ITS NAME FROM THE INCIDENT OF KHAWLA BINT THA'LABA WHOSE HUSBAND DIVORCED HER ACCORDING TO PRE-ISLAMIC CUSTOM OF ZIHAAR WHERE A MAN COULD RENOUNCE HIS WIFE SIMPLY BY SAYING SHE WAS TO HIM LIKE HIS MOTHER. BY THIS THE HUSBAND WAS FREE FROM ALL HIS RESPONSIBILITIES TO HIS WIFE BUT SHE WAS NOT FREE TO LEAVE HIM. KHAWLA COMPLAINED OF THIS INJUSTICE TO THE PROPHET AND HER PLEA WAS HEARD. DIVINITY REVEALED THE REVOKING OF ZIHAAR.

THE SURA CONTINUES FROM DOMESTIC MATTERS TO THE SECRET CONVERSATIONS (NAJWA) TO DISRUPT PUBLIC MEETINGS (SHURA). THE PROPER MANNER IN WHICH TO HOLD PUBLIC AND PRIVATE DISCOURSE FOLLOWS. A DIRECTIVE TO GIVE CHARITY BEFORE CONVERSING WITH THE PROPHET IS MENTIONED IN VERSE 12.

THE LONGEST SECTION ADDRESSES THE NATURE OF THE HYPOCRITES AND THEIR OPPOSITION TO THE PROPHET AND THE CHAPTER CONCLUDES WITH A LONG VERSE REGARDING THE REWARDS FOR THOSE WHO BELIEVE IN ALLAH AND ACCOUNTABILITY WHERE FAITH IS INSCRIBED ON THEIR HEARTS.